

A SELLER STRATEGY GUIDE

5 questions every Greater Boston seller should ask before choosing between *listing and a cash offer*.

Most sellers only hear one option: list it. **This guide is for the people whose situation is not that simple.**

If you inherited a home, own a property that needs work, are done being a landlord, are downsizing, or simply want to compare the numbers before committing, these are the questions worth asking first.

The strategy session that goes with this guide is built to answer them for your specific home in today's Greater Boston market. Think of it as a working session, not a sales call.

Krista Recker · Greater Boston Real Estate · Strategist for complicated sales

THE 5 QUESTIONS

i. What would my home realistically net on the open market versus a cash offer?

The two paths can lead to very different results. The open market often brings a higher gross sale price, but it can also come with commissions, concessions, inspection negotiations, carrying costs, and more time.

A cash offer usually comes in lower on price, but it can reduce many of those line items and shorten the timeline significantly. **Good decisions start with the net, not the headline number.**

ii. How much would I spend on repairs, clean-out, or updates, and would I actually get that money back?

Some work is worth doing. A lot of it is not.

In Greater Boston, the return on repairs depends on location, price point, buyer expectations, and the condition of competing homes. For inherited or distressed properties, clean-out alone can be one of the biggest expenses. **The goal is to identify which improvements actually move the closing number** and which ones just eat into your proceeds.

iii. How fast do I truly need to sell, and what is that timeline worth in dollars?

Timeline is one of the most overlooked parts of a seller's decision.

A six-week sale and a six-month sale can produce very different outcomes once carrying costs, taxes, insurance, maintenance, and risk are factored in. If you need certainty by a specific date, that timeline has real financial value and should be part of the strategy from the start.

iv. What are the biggest ways Greater Boston sellers in my situation accidentally leave money on the table by choosing the wrong path too quickly?

Each type of seller tends to make a different expensive mistake.

Inherited homes are often listed before the right repairs or clean-out plan is scoped. Tired landlords sometimes accept the first cash offer without understanding what the open market might have produced. Downsizers can price emotionally instead of strategically. Homes with deferred maintenance may be pushed to market without the preparation needed to attract the right buyers. The right strategy catches those patterns before they cost you.

v. If we stress-test the sale against real risks, which option holds up better?

A sale can look great on paper and still fall apart once real-world issues show up.

Inspection negotiations, appraisal gaps, financing delays, title issues, probate complications, and buyer fallout all affect the true strength of an offer. The better question is not just which path promises the highest number, but **which one is most likely to hold up and still produce the best result if something goes sideways.**

READY WHEN YOU ARE

Book your *free seller strategy session.*

In **30 minutes**, we walk through all five questions for your specific home and compare the likely numbers side by side.

WHAT YOU GET

- **Open market vs. cash offer** Side-by-side numbers, with the math explained.
- **What repairs are worth it** A practical look at which costs may help and which may not.
- **A clearer selling path** A recommendation based on proceeds, timing, and certainty.

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30 MINUTES · NO COST · NO OBLIGATION

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